

Chapter 101-4

//

When Liang Shi got back, Xu Qingzhu was in the kitchen.

As if she had discovered a new hobby, Xu Qingzhu had been going to the kitchen more frequently lately.

Often when Liang Shi woke up in the morning, she would find her in the kitchen, always tinkering with some "dark cuisine." However, none of it had been fed to Liang Shi—Xu Qingzhu had probably eaten a little of it herself.

After all, Liang Shi had discovered the remnants of those "dark cuisine" dishes when cleaning up the kitchen.

The benefit of having moved to a new place was that it only took a few steps to get from the entrance to the kitchen.

Night had fallen. Xu Qingzhu stood in front of the counter, her silhouette slender. Hearing the footsteps, she didn't turn around, her cool voice greeting unhurriedly, "You're back?"

Liang Shi responded, "Mm."

"How did you know it was me?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu said, "After living together for so long, I can tell from the sound of your footsteps."

Liang Shi: "....."

She had forgotten that Xu Qingzhu had very good hearing.

Because she had gotten Qi Jiao's diary, Liang Shi's mood wasn't very good. But standing in the kitchen at this moment, with the bright incandescent light shining down, illuminating the entire space as bright as daylight, it also drove away her bad mood. She stepped forward and asked Xu Qingzhu, "What are you planning to make?"

Xu Qingzhu said, "Congee. I bought some vegetables from downstairs."

"Eating so light?" Liang Shi said as she went to lift the pot lid. But because she was absent-minded and lifted it carelessly, her fingers touched the hot edge. The pain made her gasp, and she quickly put the lid back down, making a bang.

The kitchen suddenly became lively.

Unlike the quiet atmosphere from before, Liang Shi immediately put her fingers to her mouth and blew on them. Her fingernails were bright red.

Xu Qingzhu also heard the sound and turned to look. She saw Liang Shi with her eyes lowered, fingers near her mouth, gently blowing air on them.

From her angle, Liang Shi's long hair hung down and covered most of her face, making it impossible to see her expression clearly. But from her movements, one could tell... it really hurt.

Xu Qingzhu put down what she was holding and walked over to ask, "What happened?"

She immediately noticed her bright red fingertips and frowned, saying quietly, "How could you be so careless?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together. "I forgot."

Her voice was very low, carrying a hint of sullenness. Xu Qingzhu took hold of her wrist and pushed up her sleeve.

The silver-white bracelet on her arm looked especially beautiful, making her skin appear even more fair. Xu Qingzhu's hands were small—she actually couldn't completely encircle Liang Shi's wrist in her palm.

Liang Shi's bright red fingertips were completely different from the color of her palm. Turning on the cold water, the water flowed over Liang Shi's reddened fingers.

Xu Qingzhu had her head lowered. Liang Shi suddenly said, "Xu Qingzhu, your hair has fallen down."

Xu Qingzhu didn't bother with it, only asking her, "Does it still hurt?"

Liang Shi shook her head, wanting to withdraw her fingers, but only managed to curl them a few times in Xu Qingzhu's hand without success.

Xu Qingzhu said, "Rinse it a bit more."

The cold water dissipated the burning heat from before. In the small space stood the two of them, their bodies close together. Liang Shi only had to turn her head slightly to see the ends of Xu Qingzhu's hair.

If there was anywhere on Xu Qingzhu that resembled Sheng Yu, it was probably her hair.

Both of them had fine, soft hair. Young Sheng Yu's hair color wasn't pure black either, but had a brownish tint—exactly like Xu Qingzhu's. When she grew up, she probably wouldn't even need to dye her hair.

The bright incandescent light illuminated this small space exceptionally well. Liang Shi's fingers were still held between Xu Qingzhu's, but her thoughts had already drifted off to who knows where—she could even space out while looking at Xu Qingzhu's hair.

Xu Qingzhu lowered her head and held her fingers under the cold water to rinse them. Only after confirming there was no major problem did she turn off the faucet. The sound of flowing water disappeared in an instant.

What remained in the kitchen was the small flame on the gas stove, the silver pot, and the congee inside constantly bubbling. Steam rose from the pot and dispersed throughout this small space, like the misty haze of a mountain morning—beautiful as if from a dream.

"I got Qi Jiao's diary today." Liang Shi was the first to speak, breaking the silence.

Xu Qingzhu tucked her hair back while putting on thick gloves to lift the pot lid. Her loose sleeves hung down, and the steam passed through her sleeves and landed on her skin.

"Rainbow gave it to you?"

Liang Shi nodded. "It's a diary written in Morse code."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

That was indeed surprising.

But what was even more surprising was, "Rainbow translated it?"

"She translated one page. The rest was translated by Big Brother." Liang Shi told Xu Qingzhu everything that had happened in the car earlier in full detail. Xu Qingzhu then looked at the diary entries she had typed in the notes app.

The kitchen fell quiet. After a long while, Xu Qingzhu suddenly smiled. "So warmth can be passed on after all."

Qi Jiao had once told Liang Shi that big sisters are supposed to protect little sisters.

Liang Shi had once said to her during their days of fleeing together that big sisters should protect little sisters.

Liang Shi didn't understand. "What do you mean?"

Xu Qingzhu smiled but didn't elaborate, directly changing the subject. "It's nothing. Teacher Liang, get the utensils. Time to eat."

Liang Shi was confused but didn't ask further.

She didn't know if Xu Qingzhu's cooking skills had improved, but her congee-making abilities had certainly progressed quite a bit, and she liked to make different kinds of congee.